19.5.3 Parts of skeleton

The skeletal system is composed of bones and the related structures that aid body movement. It is divided into two major parts: the axial skeleton and the appendicular skeleton.

I. Axial skeleton

The **axial skeleton** consists of the bones along the *axis*, or central line of the human body. The axial skeleton consists of the skull, facial bones, sternum, ribs, and vertebral column.

a. Skull

Skull is a hard structure made up of small bones. It is formed by 22 bones out of which 8 bones are fixed together to form the cranium and 14 bones fuse to form the face. The only bone which has movable joint is the lower jaw. This movable joint is supported by muscles and ligaments. Skull placed on the top of the backbone can be moved up, down and sidewards.

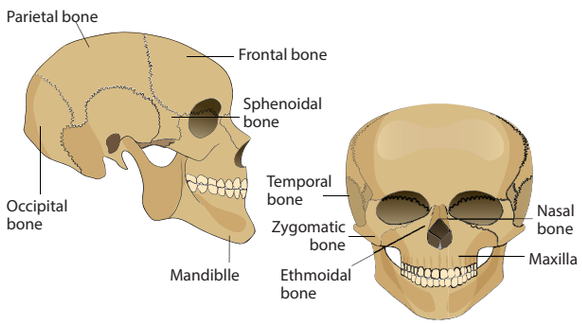


Figure 19.9 Skull bone in human

b. Vertebral column

Vertebral column running at the back of the body is also called as spine or the backbone. It is in the trunk region to offer support to the upper part of the body. Vertebral column is made up of individual bones called as vertebrae. Total vertebral column consists of 7 cervical vertebrae, 12 thoracic vertebrae, 5 lumbar vertebrae, 5 fused sacral and 3 fused coccygeal vertebrae. Vertebral column runs from the base of the skull to the hip bone forming a tube. Spinal cord passes through this hollow tube. Vertebrae are joined by gliding points which allow the body to be bent back, front or side wards.

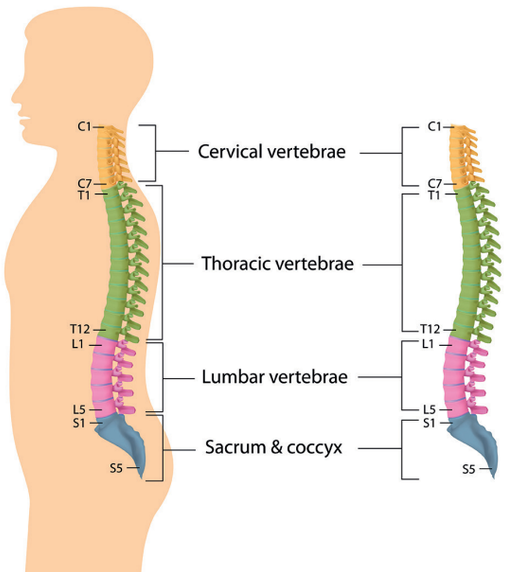
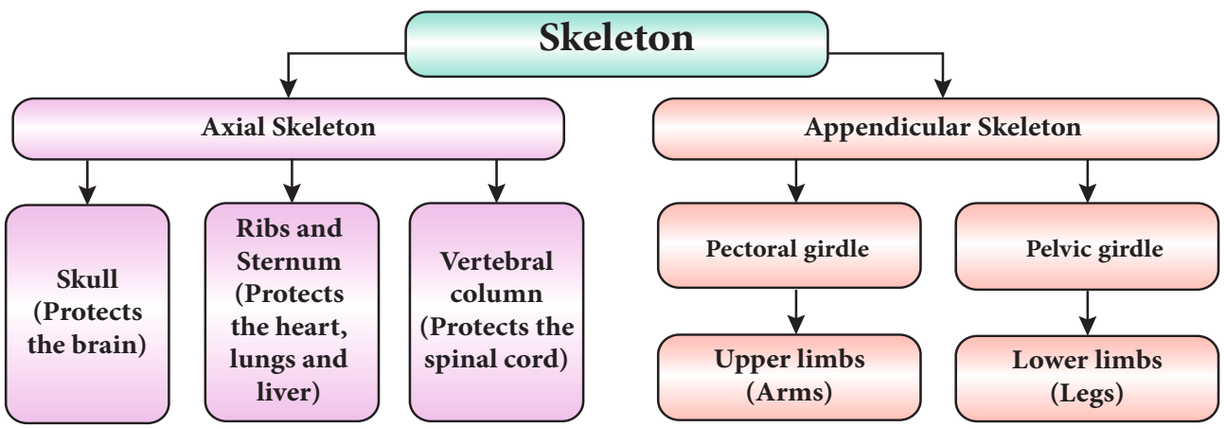


Figure 19.10 Vertebral column in human



8th_Science_Unit-19_EM.indd 225 23/02/2024 12:36:44